Denver Forward Therapy Notice of Privacy Practices

This notice describes how mental health information about you may be used and disclosed, and how you can get access to this information. Please review it carefully.

Denver Forward Therapy
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Effective date: December 1, 2026

I am required by law to protect the privacy of your health information, to give you this notice of my legal duties and privacy practices, and to follow the terms of the notice currently in effect. In this notice, "I" and "me" mean William Flug, MSW, LCSW, and Denver Forward Therapy. Your health information includes your records, session notes, billing information and anything else that identifies you and relates to your care.

How I use and share your information

I may use and share your health information without your written permission for the following purposes. I share only the minimum information needed.

- **Treatment.** To provide and coordinate your care. For example, I may consult with another licensed clinician about your treatment without sharing your name or other identifying details. I will share information with your other providers only with your written permission.
- **Payment.** To collect payment for services. For example, I prepare superbills that you can submit to your insurance company. Denver Forward Therapy is a private-pay practice and does not send claims to insurers on your behalf.
- **Practice operations.** To run my practice, such as scheduling, record keeping, billing, quality review and legal or accounting advice.
- **Business associates.** I use outside companies that handle information for me, such as my electronic health record system, telehealth platform, payment processor and, with your separate written consent, Pocket, an AI note-taking tool that records sessions to help me write clinical notes. Each company signs a Business Associate Agreement requiring it to protect your information and use it only for the work it does for me.

- **Appointment reminders.** To contact you about appointments, using the phone number or email you give me.

When I may share without your permission

Federal and Colorado law require or allow me to share information without your permission in these situations:

- **Child abuse or neglect.** I must report suspected abuse or neglect of a child to the county department of human services, the Colorado Child Abuse and Neglect Hotline or law enforcement.
- **At-risk elders and adults.** I must report suspected abuse or exploitation of an adult aged 70 or older, or of an at-risk adult with an intellectual or developmental disability, to law enforcement.
- **Serious threats of violence.** If you communicate a serious threat of imminent physical violence against a specific person or people, or against a specific place or organization, I must take steps to protect them, which may include warning them and notifying law enforcement.
- **Serious risk to your safety.** I may share information to prevent or lessen a serious and imminent threat to your health or safety, such as contacting emergency services. For clients who are minors, I must notify a parent or guardian of a clear and imminent threat of suicide.
- **Court and legal proceedings.** In response to a court order, or a subpoena when the law allows. When possible, I will tell you first so you can object.
- **Health oversight.** To agencies that oversee my practice, such as the Colorado State Board of Social Work Examiners, for audits, investigations and licensing.
- **Law enforcement.** When the law requires it, or if a crime is committed on my premises or against me.
- **Public health and government functions.** When required for public health activities, specialized government functions or workers' compensation claims, as the law allows.
- **Coroners and medical examiners.** When the law requires it after a death.
- **As otherwise required by law.** I will share information when any other federal, state or local law requires it, and only to the extent required.

Uses that need your written permission

For any use or disclosure not described in this notice, I will ask for your written permission (an authorization). You can withdraw it at any time in writing, except for information I already shared while it was in effect.

- **Psychotherapy notes.** If I keep personal notes about our sessions separate from your clinical record, I will not share them without your written permission, except where the law requires it.
- **Recording sessions.** I record or transcribe sessions with an AI tool only with your separate written consent, which you can withdraw at any time without affecting your care.
- **Sharing with family or others.** I share information with family members, friends or other providers only with your permission, unless an exception above applies. For clients under 18, see the section on minors in the Disclosure Statement and Informed Consent.
- **Marketing.** I will never use your information for marketing without your written permission.
- **Sale of information.** I will never sell your health information.

Your rights

To use any of these rights, contact me in writing at the address or email above.

- **See and get a copy of your records.** You can ask to see or get a copy, paper or electronic, of your health information. I will respond within 30 days and may charge a reasonable, cost-based fee. In limited cases I may deny access, such as when it could cause serious harm; I will explain why in writing, and you can ask for the decision to be reviewed.
- **Ask me to correct your records.** If you believe information is wrong or incomplete, you can ask me to amend it. I may say no, but I will tell you why in writing within 60 days, and you can submit a statement of disagreement.
- **Ask for confidential communications.** You can ask me to contact you in a specific way, such as only by cell phone or at a different address. I will agree to reasonable requests.
- **Choose regular email or text.** If you ask me to communicate with you by regular (unencrypted) email or text, I will explain the risks to your privacy. If you still prefer it, I will honor your request.

- **Ask me to limit what I use or share.** You can ask me not to use or share certain information. I am not required to agree, except when you have paid in full out of pocket and ask me not to share that information with your health plan.
- **Get a list of disclosures.** You can ask for a list of the times I have shared your information in the past six years, other than for treatment, payment, practice operations and disclosures you authorized. One list per year is free.
- **Get a copy of this notice.** You can ask for a paper copy at any time, even if you received it electronically.
- **Be notified of a breach.** I will tell you promptly if a breach occurs that may have compromised the privacy or security of your information.
- **Choose someone to act for you.** If you have a legal guardian or someone with medical power of attorney, that person can use your rights for you.

My responsibilities

- I am required by law to keep your health information private and secure.
- I will follow the practices in this notice and give you a copy of it.
- I will not use or share your information other than as described here unless you tell me I can in writing.
- I keep clinical records for at least seven years after our last contact, as Colorado law requires.

Changes to this notice

I can change this notice, and the changes will apply to all information I hold about you. The current notice will be available on my website and in my office, and I will give you a copy on request.

Questions and complaints

If you have questions or believe your privacy rights have been violated, contact me first: William Flug, MSW, LCSW, Denver Forward Therapy, 1325 South Colorado Boulevard, Suite B108, Denver, CO 80222, (720) 495-3924, will@denverforwardtherapy.com.

You can also file a complaint with:

- **U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Civil Rights:** www.hhs.gov/ocr/complaints or 1-800-368-1019
- **Colorado State Board of Social Work Examiners:** 1560 Broadway, Suite 1350, Denver, CO 80202, 303-894-7800

I will never retaliate against you for filing a complaint.

Acknowledgment of receipt

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Denver Forward Therapy Notice of Privacy Practices.

Client name: _____ Date of birth: _____

Client signature: _____ Date: _____

Parent or guardian (if client is a minor): _____ Date: _____